## *5.3.2 AWS Identity and Access Management (IAM)*

Figure 5.6 shows an overview of all the core concepts of the *Identity and Access Management* (IAM) service. This service provides authentication and authorization for the AWS API. When you send a request to the AWS API, IAM verifies your identity and checks whether you are allowed to perform the action. IAM controls who (authentication) can do what (authorization) in your AWS account. For example, is the user allowed to launch a new virtual machine? The various components of IAM follow:

- An *IAM user* is used to authenticate people or workloads running outside of AWS.
- An *IAM group* is a collection of IAM users with the same permissions.
- An *IAM role* is used to authenticate AWS resources, for example, an EC2 instance.
- An *IAM identity policy* is used to define the permissions for a user, group, or role.